Japan designed the exit sign you see everywhere



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It doesn’t need translating

The running exit figure was designed in Japan and became an international standard in 1987.



Where pictograms work



Steps — How to use the product

Pack — Warnings and care instructions

Space — Store signage and wayfinding

Screens — App icons and onboarding

02

Tokyo 2020, live

At the opening ceremony, performers acted out all 50 sport pictograms.

The clips spread around the world.



What makes one work



One action Per icon

One system Same figure and line weight

Tested With people who don’t read the language

Before you translate, ask what you could draw instead.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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